THE AI INNOVATOR

Concept-to-Market Challenge

Date: 14 April 2026
Format: Individual or Team of 2
Tools: Your brain, Google, pen and paper, any software you already know

MR MAURITANIA | 🍇 GRAPES | 🐝 BEE | 👨‍✈️ FLYING | 🏚️ HAUNTED HOUSE

Your challenge: Starting from five random creative parameters, execute a full concept-to-market pipeline. Each step builds on the output of the previous one. You will move from a short story to a research question, a validated problem, a designed solution, a working prototype, a landing page, and a pitch deck. Work through every step yourself. Estimate how long the entire exercise would take you, then write that estimate at the top of your submission.

a **Short Story**
Write a single-paragraph story that weaves together all five parameters above. The story should be vivid, specific, and set in Mauritania.
CREATIVE WRITING

b **Research Question**
Transform your story into a genuine research question suitable for a Masters dissertation. It must be specific, researchable, and grounded in a real academic domain.
RESEARCH

c **Problem Statement**
Research and diagnose a real problem or opportunity inspired by your question. Write a clear problem statement that identifies a narrow customer or user segment in any sector.
RESEARCH

d **Solution Design**
Design a solution: a physical product, a service, or a hybrid. Define who the provider is (startup, government agency, corporation, NGO, etc.) and describe the offering in detail.
DESIGN

e **Prototype + Design Specs**

Create a prototype with design specifications: features, architecture, user flows, brand guidelines, and an MVP development timeline.

BUILD

f **Landing Page**

Design and build a professional landing page for your solution. It should include real imagery, a clear value proposition, pricing, and a call to action. Deliver as a working HTML file.

BUILD

g **Business Plan + Investor Pitch Deck**

Write a business plan and marketing campaign. Create a visually striking slide deck (10 slides) pitched to YCombinator, TechStars, Dogpatch Labs, and BlackRock Capital. Slides should use bold statements, large numbers, photos, and data visualisations. Minimise text; maximise visual impact. When relevant, add progressive reveal of key elements within slides. Final slide: 6 or 7 bullet points on lessons learned.

BUSINESS

h **Publish Online**

Create the project folder at ~/ai-innovator/projects/[ProjectName]/ (create directories if needed). Save each step as a separate file (01-story.md, 02-research-question.md, 03-problem-statement.md, 04-solution-design.md, 05-prototype.md, index.html, pitch.html, 07-business-plan.md) so the full innovation trail is preserved. Publish to a live URL (GitHub Pages, Netlify, or similar). Share the link.

DELIVER

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"From five random emojis to a live startup. How long would it take you?"